

YANG (JUSTIN) MENG

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EDUCATION

The University of Chicago, IL

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Sept. 2025 – Present

Advisor: Prof. Yuxin Chen

The University of Chicago, IL

B.S. in Computer Science, Mathematics

Oct. 2021 – June 2025

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on continual and lifelong learning for foundation models and autonomous agents. I study how learning systems can acquire, transfer, and refine knowledge through ongoing interaction and accumulated experience. To address these questions, I develop and apply active learning and reinforcement learning methods. Another thread of my research explores machine learning for scientific discovery, with projects spanning PDE modeling, quantum materials, and spectrometer design.

PUBLICATIONS

Shared Actors Need Not Share Critics: Effects of Value Mismatch in Parallel Reinforcement Learning

Zhenya Liu, **Yang Meng**, Zhuokai Zhao, Xuefeng Liu[†], Yuxin Chen[†].

Under review

Rethinking Transfer in Continual Learning: A Replay-Based Realisation

Yang Meng, Zhenya Liu, Zhuokai Zhao[†], Yuxin Chen[†].

Under review

Active Feature Acquisition by Distilling an Oracle Teacher

Yang Meng, Zixin Ding, Robert L. Grossman, Yuxin Chen.

Under review

World Model as High-Fidelity Simulators of Scientific Processes

Yang Meng, Sherry Yang.

Under review

Accelerating PDE Surrogates via RL-Guided Mesh Optimization

Yang Meng, Ruoxi Jiang, Zhuokai Zhao, Chong Liu, Rebecca Willett, Yuxin Chen.

AISTATS 2026

Personalized Incentive Alignment: Correcting Utility-Driven Selection Bias in A/B Tests

Jiachun Li, **Yang Meng**, David Simchi-Levi, Chonghuan Wang.

AISTATS 2026

CRF-based Recognition of Invasive Fungal Infection Concepts in CHIFIR Clinical Reports

Yang Meng, Vlada Rozova, Karin Verspoor.

ALTA 2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant for Professor Yuxin Chen (UChicago CS)

Oct. 2024 – Present

Research Intern for Professor David Simchi-Levi (MIT IDSS)

Feb. 2024 – Feb. 2025

Research Assistant for Professor Haihao Lu (MIT Sloan)

Aug. 2023 – Mar. 2024

Research Intern for Professor Karin Verspoor (RMIT CS)

May 2023 – Oct. 2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Banxa Crypto

Apr. 2023 – Aug. 2023

Software Engineer Intern

- Built and maintained web application features in JavaScript and Vue3 for cryptocurrency on/off ramps.
- Implemented and optimized third-party integrations, streamlining payment processing workflows.

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Conference Reviewer: AISTATS 2026, NeurIPS 2026

Journal Reviewer: IEEE TNNLS, JMLR